**Perseverant Digital**
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A FIELD GUIDE FROM PERSEVERANT DIGITAL

# The Seminar Seat-to-Client Playbook

Plan an educational seminar or webinar that fills seats, gets registrants to actually show up, and turns the people in the room into booked consultations.

THE SHORT ANSWER · 60 WORDS

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Educational seminars and webinars still work when the decision is large and the buyer wants to learn before talking to anyone. Pick a topic phrased as the question your audience already has, promote two to three weeks out, send reminders by email and consented text, teach without pressure, and call every attendee within 72 hours to book the next conversation.

## Is an event right for your business?

An event is worth the effort when the decision is large, the buyer wants to learn before talking to anyone, and you have someone who can teach in plain language. People are not only searching to find you; they are searching to understand you. A good event lets them do that in an hour.

- [ ] Buyers hesitate for weeks or months because the decision costs or matters a lot.
- [ ] You have a presenter who explains clearly and does not oversell.
- [ ] You can name one next step, such as a consultation, a home assessment or a tour.
- [ ] Someone can call every attendee within a day or two.

All four checked means an event is worth a trial. Otherwise, fix the gaps first.

## What this looks like for a high-value service business

The pattern holds across industries. Pick the question your buyers ask before they are ready to talk, teach it honestly in an hour, and make the next step clear. Check whether your field has its own advertising rules, as law and healthcare do, and whether your ads fall under one of Meta's Special Ad Categories for housing, employment or credit. Then put most of your effort into follow-up, because that is where booked consultations come from.

## What topic will actually fill seats?

Phrase the topic as the question your audience already asks, not as your service name. A title that names their worry fills seats. Rewrite these in the words your clients use on the phone.

| Example industry | Topic phrased as the audience's question |
|---|---|
| Estate planning | Do you need a trust, or is a will enough? |
| Dental implants | What full-arch implants involve, from first visit to final teeth |
| Solar | How to read a solar quote: total cost, financing and tax credits |
| B2B services | What [the service] really costs compared with doing it in-house |
| Any high-value service | What to ask before you hire a [your trade]: the questions that matter |

| Question my clients ask most | Who asks it | Could I teach it in 45 minutes? (Y/N) |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |

## Should it be in person, a webinar or both?

Go in person when trust is the main barrier and the audience is local. Go webinar when the audience is spread out or busy. Choose hybrid only if you can staff two rooms at once.

| Factor | In person | Webinar | Hybrid |
|---|---|---|---|
| Builds trust | Fastest | Moderate | Strong in the room only |
| Cost per attendee | Higher | Lower | Highest to run well |
| Biggest risk | Empty seats you paid for | Low live attendance | Neither audience gets full attention |

Judge any format by cost per booked consultation, not cost per registration.

## What does the 21-day timeline look like?

Promote two to three weeks out, as ON24, an enterprise webinar platform, advised on November 26, 2025. ON24 also advises reminders one week, one day and 15 minutes before; we add a confirmation and a morning-of message for local events.

| Day | Task | Done |
|---|---|---|
| −28 | Pick topic, date, venue or platform, and presenter | [ ] |
| −24 | Build the registration page (checklist below) and confirmation email with a calendar link | [ ] |
| −21 | Test reminders end to end; launch ads, email your list, send partners a blurb to forward | [ ] |
| −14 | Second email; review cost per registration and cut what is not working | [ ] |
| −7 | One-week reminder (email, text optional) with one thing they will learn | [ ] |
| −3 | Rehearse; confirm room, tech and staff | [ ] |
| −1 | One-day reminder (email and text) with time, place or link, parking or tech note | [ ] |
| 0 | Morning-of and 15-minute texts with the address or link; run the event | [ ] |
| +1 to +3 | 72-hour follow-up (below) | [ ] |

Registration page checklist:

- [ ] Headline that repeats the topic question, with date, time and place above the form
- [ ] Three bullets on what attendees will learn, and a short factual presenter bio
- [ ] Form: name, email, phone, and an unchecked text-consent box that says they can reply STOP
- [ ] A plain line that the event is educational and nobody will be pressured

## How many registrations do you actually need?

Work backward from the seats you want filled.

Seats wanted ÷ show rate = registrations needed Registrations needed ÷ page conversion rate = clicks needed Clicks needed × cost per click = estimated ad budget

**Example numbers, not benchmarks.** For 30 people in the room at a 50% show rate, you need 60 registrations. At 15% page conversion, that is 400 clicks. At $2.50 per click, about $1,000 in ads.

For context, ON24 reported a 60% average registrant-to-attendee rate in its 2025 data (June 19, 2026). That is a vendor figure drawn mostly from B2B enterprise webinars, not a target.

| Line | Your number |
|---|---|
| Seats wanted | |
| Expected show rate | |
| Registrations needed | |
| Page conversion rate | |
| Clicks needed | |
| Cost per click | |
| Estimated ad budget | |
| Consultations booked | |
| Ad budget ÷ consultations booked | |

Run the last line after every event. It tells you whether to keep going.

## What should happen during and after the event?

Teach first and name one next step. Answer the title question in the first ten minutes, leave 15 minutes for questions, and explain exactly what happens in the consultation, assessment or tour. End with a feedback card or poll: “Would you like someone to call you?” yes or no.

Then move fast. In Harvard Business Review research on online leads (March 2011), firms that contacted leads within an hour were nearly seven times as likely to qualify them as firms that waited longer. Attendees are warmer than web leads, but the clock still applies.

| When | Attendees | Registered no-shows |
|---|---|---|
| Same day | Thank-you email with a summary and booking link | Replay or next date |
| Day 1 | Call everyone who said yes on the card | Text (with consent) offering the replay |
| Day 2 | Call remaining attendees once | Second email with one key point |
| Day 3 | Email anyone not reached with a booking link | Invite to the next event |

Track each attendee in one list: attended, wants a call, called, booked, became a client.

## What compliance items apply?

Check these before launch. This is general information, not legal advice.

- **Industry rules.** Lawyers, health providers and other licensed professions have their own advertising rules.
- **Meta Special Ad Categories.** Housing, employment and credit ads fix age targeting at 18–65+ and restrict ZIP targeting (Meta Marketing API docs).
- **Texting.** The TCPA still requires prior express written consent for autodialed marketing texts. Since April 11, 2025, people can revoke by any reasonable means, such as replying STOP, and opt-outs must be honored within 10 business days (Kelley Drye; Burr & Forman).

- **Email.** CAN-SPAM covers B2B email too: accurate headers, a postal address and opt-outs honored within 10 business days (FTC). Bulk Gmail senders also need SPF, DKIM and DMARC (Google, February 1, 2024).

## Where do most owners get stuck?

> **Filling seats at a sane cost.** The first event shows your real cost per registration. Lowering it takes testing topics, audiences and creative across several events before the money runs out.

> **Reminder automation across email and text.** A sequence that pulls from your form, respects text consent, honors STOP and stops for cancellations takes systems work most teams do not have time for.

> **Attribution from seat to signed client.** Most owners know how many people registered. Few can tell which ad, topic or event produced the clients who signed three months later. That needs one connected record from click to close.

If any of these sound familiar, a 25-minute exploration call can help you sort out the next step. Use the short form at the end of this guide.

## Sources


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- Federal Trade Commission, “CAN-SPAM Act: A Compliance Guide for Business,” accessed October 15, 2026. link
- Google, “Email Sender Guidelines,” February 1, 2024. link

- Federal Trade Commission, “Don’t Waste Your Energy: Solar Scam,” August 7, 2024. link
- Meta, “Special Ad Category,” Marketing API documentation, accessed October 15, 2026. link


## Want a second set of eyes on what you found?

Book a free 25-minute exploration call. We will look at your answers with you, name the first fixes in order, and tell you honestly if we are not the right fit.

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